aggression'. Just days before Zhou came to Delhi in April 1960 for his last summit with Nehru, protests both private and public broke out. Guha notes that the Himalayan Study Group of the Congress party urged Nehru to stand firm in the summit. The Jana Sangh organized 'a large demonstration outside the prime minister's residence' five days before Zhou's arrival. The non-communist opposition parties held 'a mammoth public meeting in Delhi, where the prime minister was warned that if he struck a deal with the Chinese his "only allies would be the Communists and crypto-Communists"'.[47] J.B. Kripalani, former Congress leader and trenchant Nehru critic, delivered 'perhaps the greatest speech that had been made on the floor of the House since Independence'. He sat down to 'vigorous applause from the opposition benches'. Parliament was frequently in uproar over China policy, with criticism also from Nehru's own party.[48] A foreign diplomat in Delhi concluded that Nehru's almost exclusive hold on foreign policy was 'broken'.[49] The prime minister may have had a massive parliamentary majority, but his room for manoeuvre was considerably narrowed, given the possibility of a revolt within his own party by the late 1950s.

In the case of China, Zhou and Mao were strongly entrenched. However, they had to keep a watchful eye on other centres of power within the CPC. Not all was well, particularly during the period 1958–62 when the so-called Great Leap Forward led to mass famine. Matters were serious enough that Mao briefly had to retreat from day-to-day leadership of the country and hand over to Liu Shaoqi. In his study of the 1962 war, American political scientist John Garver notes, 'It is now pretty well established that Mao's domestic mobilization concerns occasionally helped inspire his preference for confrontational international politics . . . In early 1959 . . . Mao was struggling to push the agricultural collectivization movement to a new high . . . In fall 1962 . . . he was also striving to revive "class struggle" in agricultural policy . . . to reverse the post-Great Leap retreat from collectivized agriculture.'[50]

Between early 1959 and the fall of 1962, China seems to have oscillated between a confrontational and a more cooperative stance in both domestic